

Music & the Mind: A Research Study exploring whether Music Festivals affect the Well-being of Listeners

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ABSTRACT

This study acknowledges that previous research has shown a relationship between well-being, music, and music festivals. The aim was to explore in detail how well-being might be affected by attending an electronic experimental music (EEM) festival. Questionnaire surveys were used to measure participants' well-being before and after attending concerts at a music festival in Berlin. Well-being was measured using questions asking about the satisfaction and importance of certain aspects of life, such as health and relationships. The first questionnaires were completed by participants before concerts began, and the second questionnaire was emailed to participants three days afterwards. The changes in mean scores were used to assess the effect of the music festival on well-being. The second questionnaire explored in more detail the participants' perceptions of their change in well-being. Results suggested there was a positive change to well-being as a result of festival attendance, specifically in relation to how the participants viewed their self-identity. Results also revealed negative experiences, suggesting the potential to explore how experiences at music festivals can negatively affect well-being.

1. INTRODUCTION

Within music psychology, research into well-being during music festivals, and the impact of concerts on well-being, is limited, with the earliest reports coming from this century. Music is known to have an impact on listeners, such as within the home. However, the impact of music at live concerts may be different due to aspects such as live performance, the cost of attending, the interaction with other listeners, as well as interaction with technology and media. Current research identifies a relationship between the emotional, social and musical aspects of live concerts, showing that each can occur independently or influence each other during the experience.

Minor, Tillmann, Brewerton and Hausman (2004) explored what listeners regarded as the most important aspects of musical performance. From over 200 responses, they concluded that auditory aspects were most important, including aspects such as sound quality and sound volume, and visual aspects were least important, including how the performers were dressed (2004: 15).

Packer and Ballantyne (2010) explored the motivations of young adults, aged between 18 and 29, for attendance, and their feelings during music concerts. They used a mixed-methods design, interviewing a focus group of ten people aged 18 to 23 to understand their experience of a range of music festivals and how their well-being was affected. They also used a questionnaire that received 130 responses

following a festival in Australia. Results from the focus group identified four important facets of music festivals: the music experience; the festival experience; the social experience; and the separation experience (2010: 167-172). The results from the questionnaire revealed that the music and festival experiences were most important, followed by social experience, and then separation experience. Age and level of education were associated with a difference in the importance of the four aspects, while gender, frequency of festival attendance and occupation showed no significant association (Ibid., 174-175).

Lonsdale and North (2011) explored how live music can help individuals to 'manage their moods, self-identity, and interpersonal relationships' (2011: 109). Their research involved four studies using questionnaires to explore reasons for listening to music, each involving 117 to 700 participants. Participants deemed listening to music an important aspect of their day, revealing that they listened to music to regulate both positive and negative moods, to engage with personal identity, for interpersonal relationships, for diversion, for arousal and for social interaction. Analysis of the first study revealed a gender difference – males spent 'significantly more money on music every month' and females were 'more likely to report listening to music to "pass the time"' (2011: 113). The final study revealed that the importance of listening to music decreased with age and that participants under 30 spent more time listening to music than those over 30.

Brown and Knox (2017) investigated the motivation behind live music attendance using a qualitative research design with 249 participants, aged from 16 to 69 years old. Participants were asked to 'list three main reasons why [they attended] live concerts' (2017: 237). Through analysis, four themes were identified as motivating: the idea that concerts were 'unique, one-off experiences'; engagement; novelty; and practicality (2017: 238-241). They found that 'few participants indicated any emotional motivations for concert attendance' (2017: 240).

Little, Burger and Croucher (2018) studied reasons for attendance through exploring music festival experiences at electronic dance music (EDM) festivals using semi-structured interviews with 12 participants aged 20 to 60. They found three themes to be of importance: the opportunity to escape, including psychological, physical and societal escape; *communitas*, including the presence of peace, love, unity and respect (PLUR), and positive social interaction; and self-reported changes including adoption of PLUR values and significant life experience (2018: 81-88). These important

themes created the possibility for ‘long-term psychological and social well-being’, suggesting that these could be reasons for attending festivals (2018: 92).

The majority of this research found that aspects such as live music, social interaction, separation from everyday life, seeing performers live, festival atmosphere, the surrender of control during live music, change in long-term social well-being, and increase in positive interaction values were all relevant during music festivals and had an impact on life following attendance. Furthermore, results of listening to music revealed personal growth in self-identity, mood management, increased social interaction and distraction from normal life.

Given the common themes identified in past research, this study endeavours to explore in more detail the impact of music upon well-being of festivalgoers. Furthermore, this study will explore possible associations of demographic characteristics with changes in well-being due to attending a music festival. Additionally, negative experiences are briefly mentioned in previous studies, but are not discussed in detail. Therefore, this study will also explore negative impacts on well-being after attending music festivals.

The main research questions were: How does the experience of attending a contemporary music festival affect well-being? Can festivals create negative changes to well-being for listeners? The research hypothesis was that well-being would positively change after music festival attendance, and that certain aspects such as age and previous knowledge of music would be associated with this change.

2. METHODS

Background. This study was undertaken as part of a project between Durham University and Humboldt University in Berlin. This study took place at an annual international music festival in Berlin, CTM, which lasted for 10 days and featured over 150 concerts as well as other workshops and exhibitions across the city. CTM is dedicated to ‘contemporary electronic, digital and experimental music, as well as the diverse range of artistic activities in the context of sound and club cultures’ (at the CTM 2020 Festival, <https://archive2013-2020.ctm-festival.de/festival-2020/programme/calendar/night/>).

Design. The study used a before and after design, using two questionnaire surveys: one handed out to participants before attending concerts, and the other sent to participants three days after the festival finished to be completed as a reflection following experiences at the festival. These questionnaires measured the well-being of participants, using questions on Life-Satisfaction from the FLZ^M questionnaire (Henrich & Herschbach, 1990). The participants were asked to create a personal code to enable the answers from both questionnaires to be matched. The participants were asked to put their email address on the pre-concert questionnaire, and this was used to send the second questionnaire to participants. The same well-being questions were used before and after the festival to allow comparisons to be made regarding the participants’

well-being. While this was the main aspect being measured, additional questions were asked in the second questionnaire regarding participants’ opinions on a change in well-being, based on previous studies by Packer and Ballantyne (2010; 2014).

Materials. The concerts used for data collection were Nakibembe Xylophone Troupe and Kamaal Williams on the 1st February 2020, and BNNT and Dan Deacon on the 2nd February 2020.

The pre-concert questionnaire was distributed by the researchers on two evenings of the festival before the concerts started and the post-concert survey was distributed by Survio. The pre-concert questionnaire had an approximate duration of 5 to 10 minutes to complete, and the post-concert questionnaire had a duration not longer than 10 minutes.

The pre-concert questionnaire consisted of the following:

- The creation of a personal code using the participant’s initials and their birthday (e.g. Helen Smith, 17th September = HS17)
- A consent form
- Questions on attendance at the CTM festival, the participant’s motivation for attending (based on findings from Packer and Ballantyne (2010)), the number of times the participant had previously attended the CTM festival, the number of people the participant attended the festival with, and the participant’s knowledge of electronic experimental music
- Questions on Life Satisfaction (taken from Henrich and Herschbach’s questionnaire (1990), in which participants rated eight aspects of life ranging from not important/satisfied to extremely important/satisfied)
- Personal questions asking about gender, age, education and nationality, and asking for the participant’s email address.

The post-concert survey consisted of the following:

- Personal code, including a reminder of how to create it
- The number of concerts the participants had attended in total during the festival
- Questions on Life Satisfaction, identical to those asked in the pre-concert survey
- A rating of personality from introvert to extrovert
- 13 questions about the participant’s participation during the concert and 18 questions on the effect of the concerts on participant’s well-being (taken from research completed by Packer and Ballantyne (2014)). The participants were asked to rate how strongly they agreed with each statement, from strongly disagree to strongly agree.
- Three open-ended questions regarding the participant’s experiences of how the concerts affected their well-being.

The FLZ^M questions used in both surveys are included in Appendix 2 alongside the original questionnaire released by Henrich and Herschbach (2000). The questions regarded the following eight factors: friends; leisure; health; income; work; housing; family; and relationships. The first half asked how important participants rated these aspects, and the second half asked how satisfied participants were with these aspects. The participants were given a 5-point scale, ranging from not important/not satisfied to extremely important/extremely satisfied (Henrich & Herschbach, 1990). The questions based on Packer and Ballantyne's 2010 research that were included in the post-concert survey are included in Appendix 3; a copy of the open-ended questions is included in Appendix 4.

Procedure. The researchers were granted access to the CTM Festival through the Q-Kolleg Project. The researchers arrived 30 minutes early to each concert. Once the public started arriving, the researchers took between an hour and two hours to approach and gain consent from individuals attending the concerts while they were waiting for the concert to start, either by the bar or in the concert venue. Participants were asked whether they would like to take part in the survey, to which each person had the opportunity to decline or accept. The aims and method of the survey were explained including the participant needing to give consent through ticking boxes and a signature, and providing an email address to allow the post-survey to be completed. Pencils were provided for the participants to use to fill in the questionnaire. All completed questionnaires were returned to the researchers, kept safe during the concert, and then locked away securely once the researchers returned to their lodgings.

Every participant that had completed the consent form, provided a signature, a personal code, and an email address, was emailed the URL link to the post-concert survey three days later. As each participant had already given their consent, this was not repeated in the post-concert survey. The participants were required to answer the post-concert questionnaire consisting of 53 questions, and the answers were automatically sent to the researchers upon completion. This survey was open for a 2-week period, after which no more responses were received.

Ethics. Ethics approval was applied for and granted by Durham University. Every participant that took part in the survey had to complete a consent form and provide their signature to show that they agreed to take part in the study. Any participant that didn't complete the consent form, provide a signature, or didn't provide either, was excluded from the study. Each participant was informed about how their data would be stored and each participant was given the opportunity to withdraw from the survey at any time. The researchers' email addresses were provided for the participants should they have wanted to withdraw after the data collection process. A copy of the consent form is attached in Appendix 5.

Data Analysis. In order to analyse the questionnaires collected in the Pre-Concert and Post-Concert surveys, several stages of analysis were completed. There were four stages of analysis:

- 1) Pre-Concert analysis, including the FLZ-M Well-Being ratings of participants, their motivation for attending, and association between demographic factors and the well-being results;
- 2) Pre to Post-Concert analysis, to assess the change in well-being of participants in the 10 valid responses;
- 3) Investigation of demographic factors on the Pre- and Post-Concert questionnaires;
- 4) More detailed analysis of the changes in well-being as a result of the music festival.

Each stage involved descriptive statistical analysis, measuring mean values and standard deviations, for measures of well-being using the FLZ^M questions and scores, and the relationships between demographic factors and well-being scores. Inferential statistical analysis was used for the second and third stages, using a paired samples t-test to measure the significance in change between the Pre-Concert and Post-Concert results, and an independent samples t-test to assess the association between demographics and change in well-being ratings. Microsoft Excel was used to carry out descriptive statistical analysis and SPSS was used to carry out inferential statistical analysis.

In addition to the descriptive statistical analysis carried out in the final stage, thematic analysis was also completed to identify important themes in the answers to the open-ended questions at the end of the Post-Concert questionnaire. In line with Braune and Clarke (2006), themes were identified through the application of codes to the initial data, the themes were then reviewed in comparison to Packer and Ballantyne's research (2010) and aligned with the four factors linked to festival experience (2006: 87). These themes have been used in addition to the quantitative analysis to provide a more in-depth analysis.

3. RESULTS

Participants. 100 questionnaire responses were collected from the pre-concert sample, 60 of which were valid. Some participants did not complete the consent form, did not provide a signature to allow use of their data, or did not provide an email address. Of the 60 valid responses from participants to the pre-concert survey, only 13 participants completed the post-concert survey. Of these, three participants' personal codes did not match with the pre-concert survey, and so only 10 responses were used in the analysis. Although 60 participants were contacted to complete the Post-Concert survey, email addresses were not always clear and therefore it is likely that not all emails reached the participants. All 60 participants from the pre-concert survey were aged 18 or over, in alignment with ethical approval. For the pre-concert results, 23 participants were female (38%), and 37 participants were male (62%), and participants were between 20 and 70 years old ($M = 33.87$; $SD = 10.01$). Of the 10 participants for whom pre-concert and post-concert

questionnaires were available, 3 participants were female (30%), and 7 participants were male (70%). The participants were between 20 and 47 years old ($M = 32.60$; $SD = 8.41$). Details of the 60 original participants, and the final 10 participants, are listed in Appendix 1.

Well-Being Ratings in the Pre-Concert Sample. Analysis of the sample of 60 valid pre-concert responses revealed that certain demographic characteristics were associated with differences in the overall rating of the FLZ-M questions, used as the measure of well-being in this study. This analysis revealed that the average well-being ratings were greater for females than males, greater for participants aged 30 and under, compared with those over 30, and greater for participants with little knowledge of Electronic Experimental Music (EEM) prior to the festival compared with those who had more knowledge of EEM. These results are displayed in Appendix 6.

Change in Well-Being Ratings from Pre-concert to Post-concert. Statistical analysis of the 10 valid matched pre-concert and post-concert responses showed that well-being scores were lower after the concert than before the concert. The mean ratings for importance were 3.76 ($SD = 1.13$) pre-concert and 3.49 ($SD = 1.06$) post-concert. The mean ratings for satisfaction were 3.61 ($SD = 1.15$) pre-concert and 3.46 ($SD = 1.11$) post-concert. Inferential statistics revealed that the change in Importance (I) was statistically significant but that the change in Satisfaction (S) was not (I: $t(9) = 2.66$, $p = 0.03$; S: $t(9) = 1.078$, $p = 0.31$).

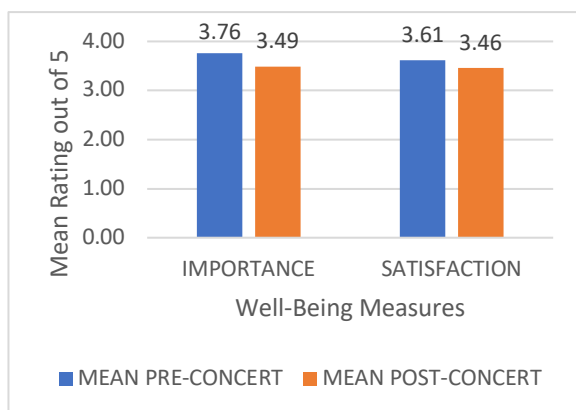


Figure 1. Differences in FLZ-M Well-Being Ratings Before and After CTM Festival Concerts

Changes in Well-Being Ratings from Pre-Concert to Post-Concert. The greatest differences in well-being ratings from pre-concert to post-concert were seen for age and the number of people the participant attended the festival with. These results are shown in Tables 1a and 1b and Figures 2a and 2b. The differences seen in analysis of well-being ratings and the other demographic factors (gender, knowledge of EEM, personality, overall number of festivals attended and previous attendance) were small.

Table 1a. Demographic Factors associated with a Change in FLZ-M Ratings of Importance from Pre-Concert to Post-Concert.

IMPORTANCE	PRE-CONCERT				
	MEANS	SD	T-TEST		
			t	df	p
AGE			2.07	8	0.07
20-30s	3.34	0.58			
30-50s	4.04	0.49			
No. People Attending with Participant			1.20	8	0.26
1	3.42	0.63			
2	3.91	0.59			

IMPORTANCE	POST-CONCERT				
	MEANS	SD	T-TEST		
			t	df	p
AGE			1.98	8	0.08
20-30s	3.06	0.66			
30-50s	3.77	0.48			
No. People Attending with Participant			0.04	8	0.97
1	3.50	0.43			
2	3.48	0.74			

Table 1b. Demographic Factors associated with a Change in FLZ-M Ratings of Satisfaction from Pre-Concert to Post-Concert.

SATISFACTION	PRE-CONCERT				
	MEANS	SD		T-TEST	
			t	df	p
AGE			0.77	8	0.47
20s-30s	3.81	0.60			
30-50s	3.48	0.71			
NO. PEOPLE ATTENDING WITH PARTICIPANT			2.67	8	0.03
1	2.96	0.31			
2	3.89	0.56			

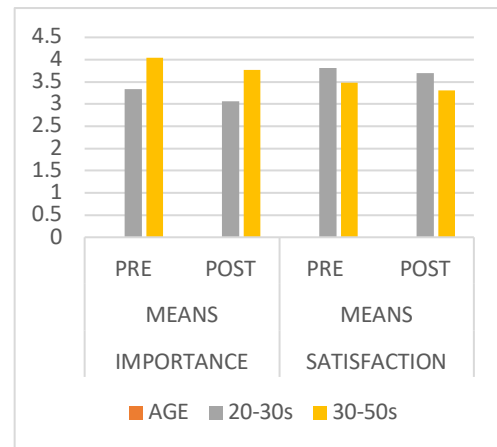


Figure 2a. Differences in Well-Being measures and Age Pre-Concert and Post-Concert measures

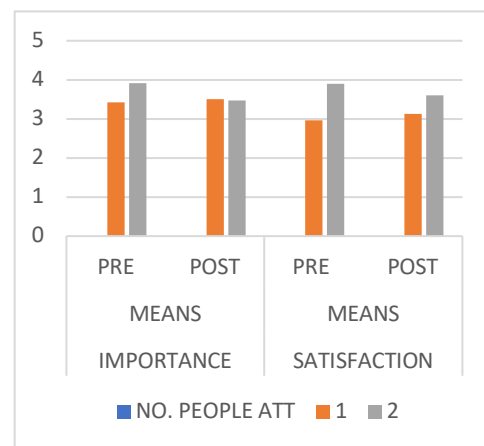


Figure 2b. Differences in Well-Being and Number of People Attending Concert with the Participant Pre-Concert and Post-Concert

SATISFACTION	POST-CONCERT				
	MEANS	SD		T-TEST	
			t	df	p
AGE			1.43	8	0.19
20-30s	3.69	0.55			
30-50s	3.31	0.28			
No. People Attending with Participant			1.83	8	0.12
1	3.12	0.13			
2	3.61	0.44			

Detailed analysis of the Changes in Well-Being in Post-Concert Questionnaire. The descriptive statistical analysis of the detailed questions regarding participation and well-being during and after the festival and the thematic analysis of open-ended questions included in the post-concert survey are shown in Table 2 and Table 3. The mean scores for the 10 responses for each question were calculated. The mean scores that were equal to or greater than 3.50, are classed as “strong”. 14 of the 31 question responses were classed as “strong” results, which suggests that the participation of participants in the festival resulted in an increased well-being.

Thematic analysis was used to identify main themes in the responses of the ten participants that answered the post-concert questionnaires. Five of the 10 respondents described a negative impact on their well-being of attending the festival. The themes in responses about well-being are included in Table 3 and a comparison is made with the themes from Packer and Ballantyne’s 2010 research to give greater insight.

Table 2. Main Themes from Quantitative Analysis of Change in Well-Being Scores in Post- Concert Questionnaires (10 participants)

Questions	Average Score across all participants
PARTICIPATION	
<i>I liked listening to this kind of music</i>	4.40
<i>I enjoyed dancing and moving to the music</i>	4.50
<i>I've participated in music making during my time at the festival</i>	1.20
<i>This music is a part of who I am</i>	4.40
<i>I've enjoyed seeing live performances</i>	4.80
<i>The festival experience has been different from anything you would find elsewhere</i>	3.90
<i>I felt connected to the people around me</i>	3.40
<i>I enjoyed dancing and moving with others</i>	4.10
<i>I have felt more open to meeting different people</i>	3.90
<i>I have enjoyed being around people with similar interests</i>	4.30
<i>It has felt like being on an adventure</i>	3.50
<i>It has been good to get away from my everyday environment</i>	3.90
<i>There were moments when I totally lost myself in the music</i>	3.60
WELL-BEING	
<i>I feel a greater sense of belonging within my group</i>	2.80
<i>I feel my relationships with others have grown/developed</i>	3.00
<i>I have a greater understanding of who I am</i>	3.20
<i>I feel inspired to do something new or creative</i>	3.80
<i>I understand my emotions better</i>	3.20
<i>I feel more able to cope with stresses in my life</i>	2.80
<i>I'm more able to make sense of what is happening in the world</i>	2.90
<i>I feel I have more things in common with others</i>	3.00
<i>I feel more positive about other people</i>	3.10
<i>I feel I now have more to contribute to the world</i>	3.20
<i>I feel more hopeful about the way things are in the world</i>	2.80
<i>I feel a greater sense of confidence/control over my life</i>	3.00
<i>I feel I have grown/developed as a person</i>	3.10
<i>I feel better able to deal with the demands and responsibilities in my life</i>	3.10
<i>I feel a greater sense of purpose in my life</i>	3.20
<i>I'm more able to accept myself for who I am</i>	3.60
<i>I feel more positive about my life</i>	3.40
<i>I feel a sense of happiness</i>	3.50

Table 3. Main Themes from Qualitative Analysis of Changes in Well-Being from Pre-Concert to Post-Concert, also using a comparison with Packer & Ballantyne's 2010 Results.

<i>Features of the festival that contributed to a change in well-being</i>	<i>Negative experiences from CTM</i>	<i>Participants' reasons for changes in well-being due to attendance at CTM</i>	<i>Packer and Ballantyne Sector of Experience Themes</i>
<i>The music</i>	<i>Too crowded</i>	Escapism	Separation
<i>Sound systems in venues</i>	<i>Long queues</i>	Adventure	Festival
<i>Interaction between performer and audience</i>	<i>BNNT 'was playing very hard music which made me feel uncomfortable'</i>	Inspiration	Festival → Personal
<i>Hearing new artists and sounds</i>	<i>Sold-out events</i>	People	Social
<i>Having artists in different contexts to their usual background</i>	<i>Costs</i>	Music	Music
<i>People</i>	<i>Appearance/Effect were made to be more important than connecting with others</i>	Separation	Separation
<i>Dancing with others</i>	<i>People using phones</i>	Understand Self / Self-Worth	Festival → Personal
<i>Diversity of music</i>		Increase in Confidence	Festival → Personal
<i>Getting lost in the music</i>		Positivity	Festival → Personal
<i>Chance of scene</i>			
<i>Adventurous programme</i>			

4. DISCUSSION

Overview of Results. The results of this study suggest there was a positive change to well-being as a result of attending the CTM Festival. Analysis of the small sample of respondents, for whom pre-concert and post-concert results were available, showed that the FLZ-M scores measuring the importance of and satisfaction with eight central aspects of life were lower in the post-concert survey than they were in the pre-concert survey. The decrease in mean ratings of life satisfaction from pre-concert to post-concert suggest CTM had a positive impact on well-being because the participants placed less importance and thought into such aspects. These findings support the research hypothesis that well-being would increase after music festival attendance. The statistical analysis showed that the post-concert mean rating for importance of the eight aspects was significantly lower than the pre-concert mean rating. The difference in the mean rating of satisfaction with the eight aspects was not statistically significant. In addition, analysis of the participants' thoughts about their change in well-being due to the festival from the post-concert survey showed that most participants experienced a positive change. Also, in the open questions, 9 of the 10 participants explained that their well-being had improved as a result of the CTM Festival, providing examples describing the improvement. Interestingly, there were seven different aspects of the festival that were considered to have made a negative impact on well-being, suggested by five participants, suggesting that there can be aspects of music festivals that can cause a negative change to well-being.

In the pre-concert survey, participants under 30 and female participants rated the importance of and satisfaction with the eight central aspects of life more highly. Interestingly, participants who attended the concert with one other person compared to two people rated the importance of and satisfaction with the eight central aspects of life more highly in the post-concert survey compared with the pre-concert survey. Furthermore, the difference in average well-being scores in the pre-concert data also reveals that those under 30 showed greater scores in well-being. This suggests that, joined with the impact on results from pre- to post-concert, those under 30 place higher importance or feel more satisfied with aspects of life satisfaction.

As a consequence of the prominence of personal aspects of the positive changes to well-being in scoring of questions about how respondents felt at the festival, I created the theme of 'personal experience' in addition to the four themes that were taken from Packer and Ballantyne's research (2010; 2014). Personal experience encompasses results such as: 'I started to understand myself as a whole better'; 'I feel valid'; it 'gave me a sense of happiness and positivity which lasted for the following days'. These results suggest that there was a longer impact on psychological well-being for the participants, in which the experiences of the festival had an impact on the everyday lives of the participants.

Given the small sample size of the post-concert survey, the results of this study, although interesting, can only suggest

patterns in effects on well-being that live music festivals may have. As five participants described a negative impact on their wellbeing from the festival in answer to the open questions, this study does suggest that negative impacts can be experienced during music festivals. However, due to the small sample size, this cannot be confidently argued and therefore suggests an area for future research, especially as there has been a lack of published research on this issue.

Comparison of Results of this Study with Previous Research. There are similarities in the results of this study to previous research, in particular Packer and Ballantyne's 2010 study. Having used the four factors from Packer and Ballantyne's 2010 study in the analysis, and questions from their 2014 research in the post-concert questionnaire, it can be seen that the changes in well-being that participants experienced at the CTM Festival were similar to those from the music festivals in Australia they used. The data from this study show a difference in well-being ratings and the impact of music festivals on those under 30 compared with those over 30, in accordance with Lonsdale and North's 2011 study. In the study completed by Brown and Knox (2017), participants' motivation for live music attendance did not include emotional impacts, however the present study clearly explained emotional impacts from the CTM Festival such as feeling 'valid' and providing a 'sense of happiness'.

Limitations of the Present Study. There are important limitations to the present study that reduce the generalisability of the findings. The major limitation is the small sample size. Although the initial data collection included 100 questionnaires, the nature of the data collection method meant that there was a large room for error in the quality and completeness of responses received. Important issues included consent not being completely given, or personal codes not created, preventing direct comparison between pre- and post-concert responses. In addition, there was no means of ensuring participants would complete the post-concert survey, particularly as participation in the study was voluntary and no incentives were provided. This means that although there are some patterns seen in the study results, they cannot be generalised to other EEM festivals or to the impact of other music festivals on the well-being of listeners. The post-concert survey sample size was too small to investigate the influence of demographic factors such as gender and previous knowledge of music on the impact on well-being and therefore a larger study would be needed to adequately explore these factors in detail.

Another limitation is that only one well-being scale was used in this study and therefore only certain aspects of well-being were measured. Furthermore, the specific well-being measure used was not specific to psychological well-being, but rather related to valuing of aspects of life. A more specific psychological well-being measure would be more appropriate for measuring the well-being of listeners.

Furthermore, the study involved a biased sample, as only 10 of the 60 original participants contributed to the comparison study and therefore those that did complete both parts of the

study were more likely to reply due to stronger feelings. Therefore, the sample used are not necessarily representative of people attending the CTM Festival. In addition, only two concerts from the 10 evenings in the CTM Festival were used for data collection and the individuals attending these concerts may not have been representative of the festival as a whole.

Future Implications of the Present Study. Due to the identified limitations of this study, I would suggest that further research could usefully explore the potential negative impact on well-being of attendance at contemporary music festivals highlighted by participants in this study. It would be interesting to explore the impact of different genres of contemporary music festivals on well-being with a study design using the same questionnaire at different festivals. Further research exploring the impact of attendance at a variety of music festivals may demonstrate that different styles of music, or the type of music festival attended, could have different effects on perceived well-being of listeners. As shown in this study, open-ended responses provide more detailed and personal information about changes in well-being and therefore a future study should aim to use qualitative research methods to gain a greater depth of insight into the impact of the change in well-being resulting from attendance at EEM festivals.

Conclusions. This study suggests that contemporary music festivals have a positive impact on listeners' well-being and have the potential to have long-lasting influences on their everyday lives. It also shows that music festivals can have both a positive and negative impact on listeners. This study suggests that the impact on well-being differs between those aged under 30 and those over 30, with the greatest impact being on those under 30 years old. However, due to limitations, the results of this study cannot be generalised and therefore future research should include planning a larger study to explore the influence of demographic factors on the impact on well-being of music festival attendance, detailed investigation into negative effects on well-being from festivals, and the use of qualitative research to give greater insight into how attendance at a music festival influences wellbeing.

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APPENDIX

Appendix 1. Copy of questions used in this study.

The following questions are about your general well-being concerning different areas of life, over **the last two weeks**. Try to not let yourself be influenced by whether you feel good or bad at the moment.

To begin with, please mark **how important** you perceive each area of life concerning your general well-being overall. Before you begin, please overview shortly all different areas.

How **important** is...

	not important	a little important	considerably important	very important	extremely important
1. Friends/Acquaintances	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Leisure activities/Hobbies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Health	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Income/Financial Security	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. Work/Occupation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. Housing situation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. Family situation/Children	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8. Relationship/Sexuality	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please mark how **satisfied** you perceive yourself to be in each area of life, over the last two weeks.

How **satisfied** are you with...

	not important	a little important	considerably important	very important	extremely important
1. Friends/Acquaintances	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Leisure activities/Hobbies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Health	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Income/Financial Security	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. Work/Occupation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. Housing situation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. Family situation/Children	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8. Relationship/Sexuality	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Appendix 2. Post-Concert Questions, based on Packer & Ballantyne (2010; 2014).

Post-Concert Questionnaire

How much do you agree with the following statements?

At this festival...

1. I have enjoyed moving to the music
2. I like listening to this kind of music
3. I have participated in music making during my time at the festival
4. The music reflects my identity and values
5. I have enjoyed seeing live performances
6. The festival experience has been different from anything you would find elsewhere
7. I felt connected to the people I was with
8. I enjoyed moving to the music with others
9. I have felt more open to meeting different people
I have enjoyed being around people with similar interests
10. It has felt like being on an adventure
It has been good to be able to get away from my everyday environment

After my time at this festival...

1. I feel a greater sense of belonging within my group
2. I feel my relationships with others have grown/developed
3. I have a greater understanding of who I am
4. I feel inspired to do something new or creative
5. I have a greater understanding of my emotions
6. I feel better able to cope with stresses in my life
7. I am more able to make sense of what is happening in the world
8. I feel I have more things in common with others
9. I feel more positive about other people
10. I feel I now have more to contribute to the world
11. I feel more hopeful about the way things are in the world
12. I feel a greater sense of confidence/control over my life
13. I feel I have grown/developed as a person
14. I feel better able to deal with the demands and responsibilities in my life
15. I feel a greater sense of purpose in my life
16. I am more able to accept myself for who I am
17. I feel more positive about my life
18. I feel a sense of happiness

Appendix 3. Post-Concert Open-Ended Questions.

1. Has the CTM festival improved your well-being? Can you tell us how?

2. What features of CTM have improved your well-being the most?

3. Can you tell us about any experiences at the festival which have had a negative impact on your well-being?

Appendix 4. Demographic Factors and Differences in Ratings of FLZM Well-Being Measurements in the Pre-Concert Questionnaire.

	<i>IMPORTANCE</i>		<i>SATISFACTION</i>	
	MEAN	SD	MEAN	SD
Gender				
Female	4.00	1.00	3.61	1.24
Male	3.83	1.04	3.51	1.19
Age				
20-30s	3.94	0.66	3.64	0.70
30-45s	3.91	0.62	3.48	0.61
Over 45s	3.72	0.74	3.48	0.90
Knowledge Rating of EEM				
1-2.5	4.09	0.56	3.69	0.86
2.5-4	3.85	0.62	3.54	0.58
4-5	3.84	0.80	3.43	0.78
No. People attending with Participant				
1	3.94	0.65	3.73	0.63
2	3.74	0.67	3.31	0.60
3	4.14	0.49	3.24	0.79
4	3.65	0.82	3.78	0.85